weirdo, but I'm also forced into a stressful, peripatetic lifestyle by the nature of the work and the facts of the organisation. We have moved around to avoid legal constraints and find stations to work from. Believe me, I feel there's nothing nicer than a set of clean towels and a dining table covered with nice food and surrounded by friends. I love a coffee machine. But it just wasn't likely to happen in a dependable way if we were doing our jobs properly and getting so far up the noses of the powerful that we became hunted. The only hope was that we might find a place, somewhere, sometime, that was disinclined to hunt people working for justice.

To my way of thinking, there was a connection between one side of our work and another, between busting companies who hid money or assets and going after governments who hid people away in places like Guantánamo. Both of these sets of perpetrators were criminals, often sanctioned by the authorities, who were hiding money or people outside the rule of law, usually in a secret jurisdiction. We could exhaust ourselves, and do, revealing evidence of what these people do; but, at some point, we might wish to see that the whole operation, the whole jurisdiction, is intrinsically corrupt. This would mean saying that the Cayman Islands, for example, must be subject to a wholesale inquiry into its offshore banking activities, and it might mean examining Guantánamo Bay as a haven allowing for the wholesale abuse of human rights as civil society understands them.

And what if you reversed this way of thinking? What if you decided there could be anti-secrecy havens in the world? In every country we had worked in, we had become aware of people and organisations living under legal or physical threat from the powerful. Whether it was Raja Petra, the editor in Malaysia, who had to flee from the authorities, or the American Home Owners Association, which was forced to move its operations onto an ISP in Sweden as a result of legal suits brought against it by property developers, or reform groups out of Russia, or great swathes of individuals targeted by the litigation-wielding malice of the Scientologists – all of them could find peace, or a fair hearing, in a haven devoted to transparency and fair play. In my understanding, a new kind of refugee had emerged in the modern world: a person, or a group, on the run from rich or powerful authorities bent on destroying them for telling the truth. We know from the work of Amnesty or PEN that these people are often writers and publishers, but they can be civil rights groups, lawyers, freethinkers, or just the